Project: Worked examples
Title: Weld group (elastic line method)
Status: DRAFT Author: TempestOS (2026-10-23) Checker: — (—) Issued: —

1. Scope and method

A group of straight fillet welds in a plane under in-plane forces (with eccentricity, so torsion), an out-of-plane force and out-of-plane moments: the resultant force per unit length at every weld end, the critical point, the throat stress against the design strength and the leg size required.
Welds as lines of unit throat: $L_w = \Sigma l$, centroid $x_c = \Sigma l \cdot x_m / L_w$ Unit second moments: $I_{ux} = \Sigma [I(y_m - y_c)^2 + I \cdot \Delta y^2/12]$, I_{uy} likewise, $J_u = I_{ux} + I_{uy}$ Torsion about the centroid: $T = F_y(e_x - x_c) - F_x(e_y - y_c) + M_z$ At each weld end: direct F/L_w, torsional $T \cdot r / J_u$ (perpendicular to r), out-of-plane $F_z/L_w + M_x \cdot y'/I_{ux} + M_y \cdot x'/I_{uy}$ with F_z's eccentricity added to M_x and M_y; vector sum f_r Throat: $a = 0.707 \cdot s$, $\tau = f_{r,max}/a$; required leg $s_{req} = f_{r,max}/(0.707 \cdot f_w)$

Ref: Shigley's Mechanical Engineering Design 11th ed., Ch. 9, Tables 9-1 and 9-2 — Welds treated as lines: torsional and bending properties
Ref: Blodgett, Design of Welded Structures 1966, §7.4 — Treating the weld as a line
Ref: EN 1993-1-8:2005 cl. 4.5.3.3 — Simplified method for design resistance of fillet welds (resistance input)

2. Inputs

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
welds	Weld lines	3 row(s)		drawing: BRK-010 rev A	any
welds[1]		x1 = 0 mm; y1 = 0 mm; x2 = 80 mm; y2 = 0 mm			
welds[2]		x1 = 0 mm; y1 = 0 mm; x2 = 0 mm; y2 = 200 mm			
welds[3]		x1 = 0 mm; y1 = 200 mm; x2 = 80 mm; y2 = 200 mm			
s	Fillet leg	8	mm	drawing: BRK-010 rev A	3 … 25 mm
f_w	Design strength of the throat	220	MPa	assumption: S275, EN 1993-1-8 simplified method: 410/√3/(0.85 × 1.25) ≈ 223 MPa, rounded down.	50 … 600 MPa

SYMBOL	DESCRIPTION	VALUE	UNIT	SOURCE	VALID RANGE
F_x	In-plane force, x	0	kN	assumption: No horizontal load.	-100000 … 100000 kN
F_y	In-plane force, y	-30	kN	spec: Hoist rating with dynamic factor	-100000 … 100000 kN
F_z	Out-of-plane force (tension positive)	0	kN	assumption: No out-of-plane load.	-100000 … 100000 kN
e_x	Point of application, x	250	mm	drawing: BRK-010 rev A	-100000 … 100000 mm
e_y	Point of application, y	100	mm	drawing: BRK-010 rev A	-100000 … 100000 mm
M_x	Out-of-plane moment about x (tension on +y side)	0	kN*m	assumption: None.	-100000 … 100000 kN*m
M_y	Out-of-plane moment about y (tension on +x side)	0	kN*m	assumption: None.	-100000 … 100000 kN*m
M_z	Additional in-plane torque	0	kN*m	assumption: None.	-100000 … 100000 kN*m

3. Assumptions

A1. Elastic, static; the connected parts are rigid and the weld stress varies linearly with distance from the centroid. (Conservative against the instantaneous-centre method.)
A2. Fillet welds only, all of one leg size; the throat is 0.707·s. (Equal-leg fillet.)
A3. The design strength of the throat comes from S4 (EN 1993-1-8 simplified method) or a user allowable with its source. (No resistance table ships.)
A4. f_w (Design strength of the throat) is taken as 220 MPa. (S275, EN 1993-1-8 simplified method: 410/√3/(0.85 × 1.25) ≈ 223 MPa, rounded down.)
A5. F_x (In-plane force, x) is taken as 0 kN. (No horizontal load.)
A6. F_z (Out-of-plane force (tension positive)) is taken as 0 kN. (No out-of-plane load.)
A7. M_x (Out-of-plane moment about x (tension on +y side)) is taken as 0 kN*m. (None.)
A8. M_y (Out-of-plane moment about y (tension on +x side)) is taken as 0 kN*m. (None.)
A9. M_z (Additional in-plane torque) is taken as 0 kN*m. (None.)

4. Working

[11] L_w = Σ l
= 80 + 200 + 80
= 360 mm
Total weld length

[12] x_c = Σ l·x_m / L_w
= 17.778 mm
= 17.778 mm
Centroid x

[13] y_c = Σ l·y_m / L_w
= 100 mm
= 100 mm
Centroid y

[14] I_ux = Σ [l(y_m − y_c)² + l·Σy²/12] Shigley Table 9-2
= about the centroid
= 2266700 mm³
Unit second moment about x

[15] I_uy = ∑ [l(x_m - x_c)² + l·∑x²/12] Shigley Table 9-2
= about the centroid
= 227560 mm³
Unit second moment about y
[16] J_u = I_ux + I_uy Shigley Table 9-1
= 2266700 + 227560
= 2494200 mm³
Unit polar moment
[17] T = F_y(e_x - x_c) - F_x(e_y - y_c) + M_z
= -30 × 232.22 - 0 × 0 + 0e3
= -6.9667 kN·m
In-plane torque about the centroid
[18] f_r_max = max over weld ends √(f_x² + f_y² + f_z²)
= at (80, 0) mm: (-279.31, -257.13, 0) N/mm
= 379.64 N/mm
Maximum resultant force per unit length
[19] critical = critical point
= (80, 0) mm
= "(80, 0) mm"
Where f_r is greatest
[20] a = 0.707 * s
= 0.707 × 8 mm
= 5.656 mm
Throat
[21] tau = f_r_max / a
= 379.64 N/mm / 5.656 mm
= 67.122 MPa
Maximum throat stress
[22] s_req = f_r_max / (0.707 * f_w)
= 379.64 N/mm / (0.707 × 220 MPa)
= 2.4408 mm
Leg size required
[23] u = tau / f_w
= 67.122 MPa / 220 MPa
= 0.3051
Utilisation

5. Results

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
L_w	360 mm	Weld length
x_c	17.778 mm	Centroid x
y_c	100 mm	Centroid y
I_ux	2266700 mm³	Unit second moment about x
I_uy	227560 mm³	Unit second moment about y
J_u	2494200 mm³	Unit polar moment
T	-6.9667 kN·m	Torque about the centroid
f_r_max	379.64 N/mm	Maximum force per unit length
critical	"(80, 0) mm"	Critical point
a	5.656 mm	Throat

SYMBOL	VALUE	DESCRIPTION
tau	67.122 MPa	Throat stress
s_req	2.4408 mm	Leg required
u	0.3051	Utilisation

6. Checks (governing first)

RESULT	CHECK	DEMAND	CAPACITY	UTILISATION	REF
PASS	Throat stress against design strength	u = 0.3051	u ≤ 1	0.305	EN 1993-1-8 cl. 4.5.3.3

7. Applicability

No warnings.

8. Verification

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